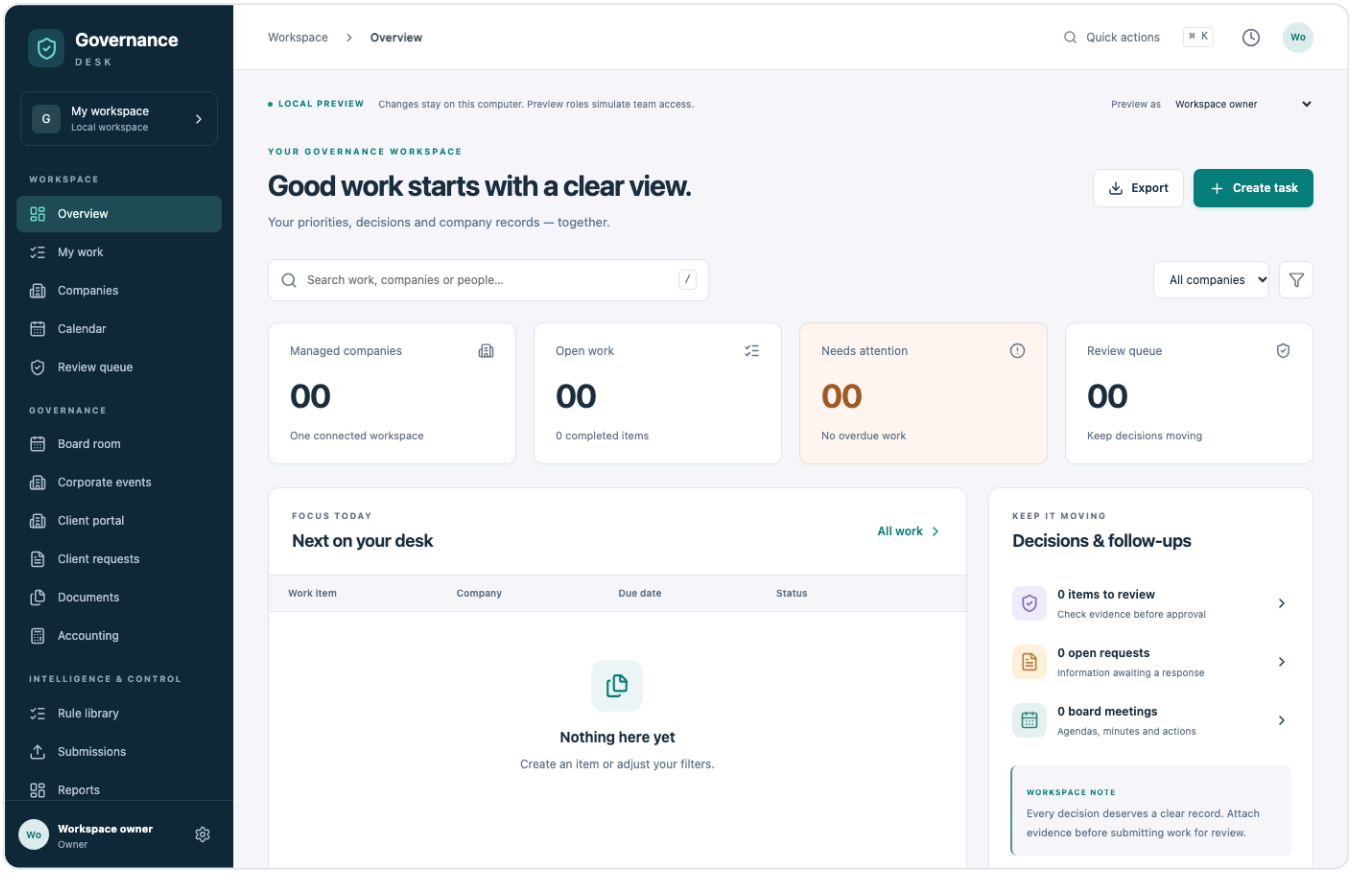
USER GUIDE

Governance Desk

How to start the app and use each part of it

Local preview edition · Project folder: `/Users/darshan/Downloads/governance`



The Overview screen, with the menu on the left and the "Preview as" role selector at the top right.

Contents

1. What Governance Desk is
2. Starting and stopping the app
3. Getting around the screen
4. Roles and "Preview as"
5. Day-to-day work
6. Board meetings
7. Corporate events
8. Documents
9. Accounting close
10. Client requests
11. Rule library and recurring work
12. Submissions
13. Reports, briefings, inbox, audit trail
14. The client portal
15. Invoices and payments
16. Optional email and AI
17. Your data and backups
18. Limits and troubleshooting

1. What Governance Desk is

Governance Desk is a workspace for a company secretary or corporate-services team that manages several client companies. It keeps the following in one place:

- board meetings
- company events, such as director changes
- accounting reviews
- documents
- compliance deadlines
- client communication
- invoices in Indian rupees (INR)

Most work needs approval: one person prepares it and a different person approves it. Every change is recorded in an audit trail.

> **This is a local preview, not a live service.** It runs only on this computer. Logins are simulated, so anyone using this computer can switch roles. The app doesn't file anything with government portals or take payments, and it sends no email unless you set that up.

2. Starting and stopping the app

Start

Open the Terminal app and run:

```
cd /Users/darshan/Downloads/governance
nvm use
pnpm preview:build
pnpm preview:local
```

When the Terminal shows `Governance Desk local workspace: http://127.0.0.1:5174`, open one of these addresses in your browser:

Address	Opens
`http://127.0.0.1:5174/`	The main workspace
`http://127.0.0.1:5174/#client-portal`	The client portal

> - Type `127.0.0.1` exactly. The app blocks `localhost`.
> - You only need `pnpm preview:build` the first time and after changing the code. Otherwise `pnpm preview:local` is enough.

Stop

Click the Terminal window running the app and press **Ctrl + C**. Your data is kept. The app opens with the same records next time.

3. Getting around the screen

The menu on the left has three groups:

Group	Screen	What it's for
Workspace	Overview	Counts of companies, open work, overdue items and items waiting for review, plus your next tasks
	My work	Tasks assigned to you
	Companies	The companies you manage and their details
	Calendar	Upcoming due dates
	Review queue	Work waiting for someone to approve it
Governance	Board room	Meetings, agendas, minutes and decisions
	Corporate events	Director appointments, resignations, office changes, share allotments and renewals
	Client portal	Onboarding new clients and working with them
	Client requests	Asking clients for information and reviewing their answers
	Documents	Uploading, versioning and sharing files
	Accounting	Trial-balance imports and period close
Intelligence & control	Rule library	Rules for recurring obligations, such as monthly, quarterly and annual work
	Submissions	A record of filings made on external portals
	Reports	Completion measures and CSV exports
	Briefings	Summaries of overdue, upcoming and review work
	Inbox	Reminders for due and overdue items
	Team & access	Team members and their roles
	Connections	Whether the optional email and AI services are set up
	Audit trail	A history of every change

Other controls on every screen:

- **Search** finds work, companies or people.
- **All companies** filters the screen to one company.
- **Export** downloads a CSV file.
- The green **Create …** button adds a new item of the kind shown on that screen.

- **Quick actions** (⌘K) jumps to common tasks.

4. Roles and "Preview as"

The app has six roles:

Role	Typical use
Owner	Full control of the workspace. This is the default when the app opens.
Secretary	Runs governance work, publishes documents and confirms payments
Accountant	Imports and prepares accounting work
Director	Takes part in board work and reviews it
Client	Sees only their own company's portal, requests and shared documents
Auditor	Reviews records

Add people in **Team & access**. Then choose a person in **Preview as**, at the top right, to see the app as they would. Use this to try approvals, because the person who approves an item must be different from the person who prepared it.

> Role sessions reset when the app restarts. They are for testing only and don't protect anything.

5. Day-to-day work

Most items, such as tasks, meetings and closes, follow the same path:

1. **Not started**: the item exists but no one has begun it.
2. **Start work**: the preparer fills in the details and attaches evidence.
3. **Submit for review**: the item moves to the **Review queue**.
4. A **different** person either approves it (**Approve work**) or sends it back (**Return to preparation**).
5. Once approved, it can be marked **complete**.

If two people edit the same item at once, the second save is rejected. Reload the item and try again.

If you upload a newer version of a document, items that depended on the old version are flagged **Review required**.

6. Board meetings (Board room)

1. Click **Create** to add a meeting and choose the company.
2. Add the agenda.
3. Add attendees and mark any conflicts of interest. Attendees with a conflict don't count towards the quorum.
4. Set the **Minimum eligible attendees** (the quorum).

5. Write the minutes and resolutions, attach evidence and assign a preparer.
6. Click **Submit for review**.
7. Switch to another person in **Preview as** and approve.
8. Add follow-up actions with due dates. Create an **evidence pack**, a printable HTML record of the meeting.

Approval needs an agenda, minutes and current evidence.

7. Corporate events

1. Choose an event type:
   - director appointment
   - resignation
   - registered-office change
   - share allotment
   - renewal
2. Set the effective date.
3. The app creates a checklist of tasks that must be done in order.

The event can be completed only after every linked task is complete.

> The checklists help organise the work. They don't include verified legal deadlines, so check them for your jurisdiction.

8. Documents

- **Upload document** stores a file of up to 10 MB in an allowed format. Each file gets a fingerprint (SHA-256) so you can tell whether it changes.
- Open a document to download it or upload a newer version. Old versions are kept.
- **Share with company portal** makes the document visible to that company's client users.

> Uploads are not scanned for viruses or malware.

9. Accounting close

1. Prepare a CSV file with the columns `account,debit,credit`. Total debits must equal total credits.
2. In **Accounting**, click **Import trial balance**. Choose the period and currency, then **Validate and import**.
3. Switch to a different person and review the import.
4. Create a **Financial close** for the same period.
5. Link the reviewed import and supporting evidence, then complete the preparation checklist.
6. Submit the close for approval.

Every import is kept as a fixed version. Importing the same file twice is detected.

Example file:

```
account,debit,credit
Cash,150000,0
Share capital,0,100000
Revenue,0,50000
```

10. Client requests

1. Create a request, describe the information you need, and assign it to a client user.
2. Switch to that client in **Preview as** and send a response.
3. Switch back to a secretary or owner. Accept the response, or ask for a correction.

11. Rule library and recurring work

1. Create a rule. Set it to repeat monthly, quarterly or annually.
2. Set the **First anchor date**, the **Days after anchor** for the due date, and a source or policy reference.
3. Submit the rule.
4. A different person publishes it.
5. **Preview** shows the next 90 days of work the rule would create. **Generate** creates those tasks. Periods that already exist are skipped, so nothing is duplicated.

12. Submissions

Use **Submissions** to record filings you make yourself on external government portals:

1. Prepare the submission and get it authorised in the app.
2. Make the filing on the external portal, outside this app.
3. Enter the reference number the portal gave you.
4. Record whether the filing was accepted or rejected, and attach the acknowledgement document.

A filing task can be completed only when there is accepted evidence.

> Authorising a submission in the app doesn't file anything with the government.

13. Reports, briefings, inbox and audit trail

- **Reports**: how much work is complete for each company, CSV exports of registers, and evidence packs you can print to PDF from the browser.
- **Briefings**: a summary of overdue, upcoming and review work, with links to the source records. A briefing is always a draft.
- **Inbox**: reminders for due and overdue items. The app checks once a minute while it's running and sends at most one reminder per item per day.

- **Audit trail**: who changed what, and when.

14. The client portal

Open **Client portal** from the menu, or choose a Client in **Preview as**.

As staff

Use **Onboard a client**. This creates:

- a draft company record
- a six-stage onboarding tracker
- a client user who can see only that company

As a client

The portal has these tabs:

Tab	What the client can do
Overview	See a summary of their company's status
Company profile	Fill in company details, such as PAN and billing address, and submit them for review
Onboarding	Track the six onboarding stages
Documents	Download documents the secretary has published, one at a time or as one ZIP file
Inbox	Exchange messages with the secretary and attach published documents
Compliance calendar	See upcoming compliance dates and download them as calendar (.ics) files
Invoices & payments	View invoices and report payments

India annual-review checklist: the secretary can create one for a chosen financial year. Its items start as **Needs scheduling**. Someone must review each date and set it for that company, because the app doesn't assume statutory deadlines.

15. Invoices and payments

1. Staff create an invoice: the service, quantity, rate in INR, tax amount, due date and payment instructions. Tax is entered by hand, not calculated.
2. Click **Issue**. After that the invoice can't be edited, and the same invoice number can't be issued twice.
3. The client pays outside the app, for example by bank transfer, using the payment instructions.
4. The client reports the payment in the portal, with the amount, date, transaction reference and proof.
5. Staff confirm or reject the report. Only confirmed payments produce a receipt.

Partial payments are supported. Overpayments, future dates and repeated transaction references are rejected.

To cancel an issued invoice, void it with a reason. You can only do this if no payments are pending or confirmed.

16. Optional email and AI

The app works fully without these services. To turn them on, edit the `.env` file in the project folder and restart the app.

Setting	What it enables
`OPENAI_API_KEY` `OPENAI_MODEL`	AI-written drafts in Briefings. Nothing is sent until you request an AI draft.
`RESEND_API_KEY` `MAIL_FROM`	Sending a reminder by email. Each email is sent only when you choose a recipient and click send.
`PORT`	Runs the app on a different port. The default is 5174.
`GOVERNANCE_DATA_DIR`	Stores data in a different folder

The **Connections** screen shows which services are set up. It doesn't test whether they actually work.

17. Your data and backups

All records and uploaded files are stored in `.sites-runtime/preview/` inside the project folder:

- `preview.sqlite`: the database
- `files/`: uploaded documents

To back up: stop the app, then copy both of these together.

To start fresh: stop the app and move that folder somewhere else. A new, empty database is created the next time the app starts.

18. Limits and troubleshooting

Not included in this version

- real logins and remote team access
- government filing
- e-signatures
- payment gateways
- malware scanning
- verified legal rule packs
- production hosting

Never make the app reachable from other computers.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Browser shows "Host not allowed"	Use `http://127.0.0.1:5174`, not `localhost`.
Page won't load at all	The app isn't running. Start it with `pnpm preview:local`.
"pnpm requires at least Node.js v22.13"	Run `nvm use` first to switch to Node 24.
Port 5174 already in use	Another copy is running. Stop it, or start this one with `PORT=5175 pnpm preview:local`.
Code changes don't appear	Run `pnpm preview:build` again, then restart the app.
Can't approve your own work	This is intended. Switch to a different person in **Preview as**.